

WORLD ASSOCIATION OF AZERBAIJANI SCIENTISTS
DÜNYA AZƏRBAYCANLI ALIMLƏR BİRLİYİ (WAAS / DAAB)

DAAB / WAAS Website — User Manual

User manual · PDF export

Audience: Visitors, members, and staff using the public website

Languages: Azerbaijani (AZ) and English (EN)

Organization: Dünya Azərbaycanlı Alimlər Birliyi (DAAB) / World Association of Azerbaijani Scientists (WAAS)

Document version: 1.0 — May 2026

This manual describes how to use the official bilingual website: what you see on screen, how navigation works, and how to complete common tasks. It is written for end users, not developers.

1. About the website

The site is a **static, bilingual** web presence. All main content exists in parallel:

Language	URL path	Brand name
Azerbaijani (default)	/az/...	Dünya Azərbaycanlı Alimlər Birliyi (DAAB)
English	/en/...	World Association of Azerbaijani Scientists (WAAS)

The site introduces the Association, publishes news and Forum 2024 materials, lists scientists who participated in the 2024 forum, explains membership, and provides an online membership application form.

2. Look and feel

2.1 Visual identity

- **Colours:** Deep blues (#005a9a family), white and light blue surfaces, gold accents on headings and card headers.
- **Typography:**
 - **Playfair Display** — page titles and major headings (serif, formal tone).
 - **Inter** — body text, navigation, forms, and tables (sans-serif, readable at small sizes).
- **Imagery:** DAAB logo, partner logos on Forum pages, scientist portraits, photo/video galleries, and occasional news images on Activities.

2.2 Layout patterns

Most pages follow a consistent structure:

1. **Top navigation bar** — fixed strip with logo, menu, language switcher, and search.
1. **Hero band** — large title, optional subtitle, and often a summary panel on the right (desktop).
1. **Breadcrumbs** (on many inner pages) — path such as Home > Activities > Forum 2024 .
1. **Main content** — articles, cards, tables, or forms.
1. **Back-to-top control** — appears after you scroll down (floating button, bottom-right).

Hub pages (Home, Forum 2024 hub) use a **card grid**: each card has an icon, title, short description, and “Read more” style link.

Long reading pages (Activities, Forum official texts, Presentations, Charter) use **content cards** with blue gradient headers and white body areas.

Scientists list uses a **data table** with filters; **Scientists profiles** uses a **card grid** with photos and QR codes.

2.3 Responsive behaviour

- **Desktop:** Full horizontal menu, two-column hero, sidebars where provided (e.g. presentations menu).
- **Tablet / phone:** Hamburger menu (☰), stacked hero, collapsible filter panels, and collapsible sidebar widgets. Touch targets are enlarged on mobile.

3. Getting started

3.1 Opening the site

1. Open the site root URL in a browser (e.g. `https://yoursite.example/`).
1. You are usually sent automatically to `/az/index.html` (Azerbaijani home), unless you previously chose English (stored in the browser).
1. To choose language explicitly, use the **gateway page**: open `index.html?choose=1` and pick **Azərbaycan dilində davam et** or **Continue in English**.

3.2 Choosing your language

On every main page, the **language switcher** appears in the top navigation (AZ / EN flags or codes).

Action	Result
Click AZ	Opens the Azerbaijani version of the same page (when a translation exists).
Click EN	Opens the English version.

Your choice is remembered for future visits. On some long pages (e.g. Activities, Charter), the site tries to keep you at the **same section** after switching language.

3.3 Skip link (accessibility)

The first focusable control on many pages is **“Skip to content” / “Məzmunə keç”**. Press **Tab** once after loading the page, then **Enter**, to jump past the navigation to the main content.

4. Global user interface elements

4.1 Top navigation bar

Element	Appearance	What it does
Logo	DAAB emblem, left	Returns to home (<code>/az/</code> or <code>/en/</code>).
Site name	Two-line title next to logo	Also links to home.
Menu items	Text links; some with ▼ caret	Opens pages or dropdown panels.

Element	Appearance	What it does
Hamburger (mobile)	Three lines, top-left	Opens/closes the full menu.
Language switcher	AZ / EN	Switches site language (see §3.2).
Search	Magnifying glass or search field in nav	Opens site-wide search (see §4.2).

Main menu structure (labels differ slightly in EN):

Top item	Sub-items
Home	—
Activities	News · Forum 2024
Scientists	Directory (list) · Profiles
About us	Foundation · Mission & values · Board of Directors · Charter
Membership	Why become a member · Membership terms · Join us (application)

Dropdown panels show a **title** and a **one-line description** for each link. The current section is highlighted.

How to use dropdowns (desktop): Click the parent label (e.g. “Scientists”) or hover (depending on device); click a row in the panel to go to that page.

How to use the menu (mobile): Tap ☰ → tap a section → tap a sub-link. Tap outside or the toggle again to close.

4.2 Site-wide search

Search finds pages and in-page sections across the current language.

How to open	
Click the search control in the navigation bar	
Keyboard shortcut	Ctrl+K (Windows/Linux) or Cmd+K (Mac)

Search overlay:

- A panel opens over the page with a text field.
- Type at least one word; results appear in a list (page titles and snippets).
- **Click** a result or use ↑ / ↓ and **Enter** to open it.
- Press **Escape** or click outside to close.

Search understands Azerbaijani characters in a flexible way (e.g. typing without special letters may still match ə, ş, etc.).

4.3 Breadcrumbs

Below the navigation on many pages, a trail such as:

Ana səhifə > Fəaliyyətimiz > Forum 2024 > Məruzələr

- Each segment except the last is a **link**.
- The last segment is the **current page** (not linked).

- Use breadcrumbs to move up one level without using the browser Back button.

4.4 Section navigation (pills)

Some long pages (Membership application, Charter, and similar) show a **horizontal row of pills** under the hero:

- Each pill jumps to a section on the same page.
- The active pill updates as you scroll (on supported pages).
- On narrow screens, pills may scroll horizontally.

4.5 Back to top

After scrolling down, a **back-to-top** button appears (typically bottom-right). Click it to scroll smoothly to the top of the page.

4.6 Hero area and subtitles

- **Main heading (H1):** Large serif title; key words may be emphasised in colour.
- **Subtitle:** Italic line under the title (loaded from site configuration); summarises the page purpose.
- **Summary panel:** Light card on the right (desktop) with a short explanation — read this for context before diving into content.

5. Home page

Path: /az/index.html or /en/index.html

What you see

- Hero with welcome message and two primary buttons: **Meet our scientists** and **Join the Association** (wording varies by language).
- Introductory text and a **search box** labelled “Search sections...” — filters the **cards below** on the home page only (not the whole site).
- **Card grid** linking to major sections: Mission, Activities, Scientists, Board, Charter, Membership, etc.

Common actions

Goal	Steps
Browse all main topics	Scroll the card grid; click any card.
Find a home-page section quickly	Type in the home search box; non-matching cards hide.
Go to scientists	Click Meet our scientists or the Scientists card.
Apply for membership	Click Join / membership card → follow links to terms and application.

6. About us

6.1 Foundation

Story of how the Association was established: narrative sections in card layout, readable body text.

6.2 Mission, vision and values

Explains purpose, strategic direction, and core values — same card/hero pattern as other About pages.

6.3 Board of Directors (Executive board)

- **Member cards** in a grid: photo (portrait frame), role, name, country.
- **QR code** on each card links to that person’s entry on the Scientists profiles page.
- Click the card area to open the full profile (where linked).

6.4 Charter

Long legal/governance document, often with:

- **Sidebar table of contents** (desktop) listing articles.
- Click an article in the sidebar to jump to that section.
- On mobile, the sidebar may collapse into a **menu button** — tap to open the list of articles.

7. Scientists

7.1 Directory (list view)

Path: /az/scientists/list.html or /en/scientists/list.html

Purpose: Searchable table of scientists who participated in the 2024 forum.

UI element	Look and feel	Use
Search field	Wide box with magnifier icon	Type name, country, field, degree, email, etc. Table filters as you type.
Filters button	Funnel icon + “Filters”	On mobile/small screens, opens the filter panel.
Country / Field / Degree dropdowns	Select boxes with emoji labels	Narrow the list; × beside each clears that filter.
Results table	Columns: photo, name, country, field, degree, email, ...	Click column headers to sort where supported.
Row click	Highlights row	Opens or focuses the scientist (depending on configuration — often links to profiles with hash).
Pagination	Page numbers at bottom	Move through large result sets.

Typical workflow: Open Filters → choose country → type part of a name → click a row to view profile.

7.2 Profiles (card view)

Path: /az/scientists/profiles.html or /en/scientists/profiles.html

Purpose: Richer **profile cards** with photo, affiliation, email, field, and a **QR code** for sharing a direct link to that profile.

Action	How
Find someone	Scroll, or use browser Find (Ctrl+F), or open a link with #scientist-id in the URL.

Action	How
Share a profile	Scan or copy link via QR / address bar (.../profiles.html#slug).
Email a scientist	Click the email link on their card (opens your mail app).

Profile cards use a rounded photo frame and structured metadata rows (label + value).

8. Activities and Forum 2024

8.1 Activities (News)

Path: /az/activities.html or /en/activities.html

- **Layout:** Left **timeline sidebar** ("News" / events list) + **main column** of news cards.
- **Sidebar:** Lists news items by date/title; click an item to scroll the main column to that article.
- **News cards:** Blue header (title/date), body text, images, external source links where present.
- On mobile, the sidebar may open via a **menu toggle** on the widget header.

8.2 Forum 2024 hub

Path: /az/forum/2024/index.html or /en/forum/2024/index.html

- Hero shows Forum title and **partner logos** (DAAB, DiDK, Ministry).
- Card grid links to all Forum sub-sections (see table below).
- Home-style **search box** filters Forum cards by title.

Card (EN examples)	Content
Official addresses	Speeches and official texts
Forum programme	Schedule tables
Presentations	Scientific presentations (sidebar + long articles)
Impressions	Participant reflections
Strategic roadmap	Policy/roadmap document
Stories of the forum	Narrative stories
Contributions and cooperation	Cooperation chapter
Photo gallery	Browse forum photos by category
Video gallery	Embedded video reports

8.3 Presentations page

Path: /az/forum/2024/presentations.html or /en/forum/2024/presentations.html

Layout:

Area	Description
Left sidebar	List of all presentations: small photo , speaker name , presentation title .
Right column	Full text of each presentation in separate cards.

Actions:

Goal	Steps
Jump to a talk	Click an item in the left sidebar → page scrolls to that presentation.
Read	Scroll the main column; body text is justified ; bullet lists use compact spacing.
Know who is speaking	Blue header shows name; lead row shows photo + presentation title.

On mobile, open the sidebar with the **≡ control** on the “Presentations” widget.

8.4 Photo gallery

- Sections/group headings with thumbnail grids.
- Click a thumbnail to view the larger image (lightbox-style behaviour where implemented).
- Thumbnails load from organised folders per event segment.

8.5 Video gallery

- Grid of video entries (thumbnails and titles).
- Click to play or open the linked video content (external or embedded players as configured per item).

8.6 Other Forum pages (official, programme, impressions, etc.)

Shared patterns:

- Breadcrumbs: `Home > Activities > Forum 2024 > [page]` .
- Long content in **stacked cards** with section headings (`program-subhead` style).
- Some pages include **tables** (programme schedule) — scroll horizontally on small screens if needed.

9. Membership

9.1 Why become a member

Benefits and value proposition — informational cards and text; links onward to terms and application.

9.2 Membership terms

Fees, rules, payment/bank details, and procedures. Read before applying.

9.3 Online application (“Join us”)

Path: `/az/application.html` or `/en/application.html`

Look and feel:

- Multi-section **form** with clear steps (personal data, academic fields, documents, etc.).
- **Section nav pills** jump between form parts.
- Required fields are marked; validation messages appear if you leave required items empty.
- Instructions explain emailing CV/photo to the Association address where uploads are not done in-browser.

How to apply:

1. Read **Membership terms**.
1. Open **Join us / Bizə qoşulun**.
1. Use section pills to complete each part of the form.
1. Submit according to on-page instructions (and send attachments by email if requested).
1. Keep a copy of any confirmation message or email you receive.

10. Tips for efficient use

Tip	Detail
Prefer navigation + breadcrumbs	More reliable than only the browser Back button on deep Forum pages.
Use site search for unknown location	Ctrl/Cmd+K, then type topic keywords.
Switch language from the header	Avoids manually editing /az/ vs /en/ in the URL.
Scientists: combine filters + search	Faster than scrolling the full table.
Presentations: use left sidebar	Long page — sidebar is the fastest table of contents.
Hard refresh after updates	If layout looks wrong, try Ctrl+F5 (Windows) or Cmd+Shift+R (Mac).

11. Accessibility features

- **Skip to content** link for keyboard users.
- **ARIA labels** on navigation, menus, and many controls (screen reader friendly).
- **Keyboard:** Tab through links and form fields; Escape closes search overlay and some menus.
- **Contrast:** Dark blue on white/light backgrounds for main text; white on blue in card headers.
- **Responsive text:** Headings scale with viewport (c1amp sizing on key titles).

12. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
“This page isn’t working” / blank connection error	Site server may be down, or wrong URL — use the address provided by your host; for local preview, start the site server and open <code>http://localhost:8010/</code> .
Page looks unstyled (plain HTML)	Wait for network; hard refresh; check you opened <code>http://</code> not <code>file://</code> for full features.
Wrong language	Use AZ/EN switcher in header.
Old content after an update	Hard refresh (Ctrl+F5) to clear cached CSS/JS.

Problem	What to try
Search shows no results	Try simpler keywords or the other language version.
Link goes nowhere	Report to site maintainers — may be outdated bookmark.
Form will not submit	Fill required fields; check error messages in red/near fields.

13. Quick reference — main URLs

Section	Azerbaijani	English
Home	<code>/az/index.html</code>	<code>/en/index.html</code>
Scientists list	<code>/az/scientists/list.html</code>	<code>/en/scientists/list.html</code>
Scientists profiles	<code>/az/scientists/profiles.html</code>	<code>/en/scientists/profiles.html</code>
Activities	<code>/az/activities.html</code>	<code>/en/activities.html</code>
Forum 2024	<code>/az/forum/2024/index.html</code>	<code>/en/forum/2024/index.html</code>
Presentations	<code>/az/forum/2024/presentations.html</code>	<code>/en/forum/2024/presentations.html</code>
Membership application	<code>/az/application.html</code>	<code>/en/application.html</code>

14. Document maintenance

This manual reflects the site structure as of **May 2026**. When navigation labels, page URLs, or major layouts change, update this file alongside `i18n/routes.json` and `i18n/ui.json`.

Related internal docs (for staff):

- `documents/DAAB-Navigation-and-Information-Architecture-Strategy.md`
- `documents/DAAB-Site-Stability-and-Deployment-Guide.md`
- `documents/DAAB-Bilingual-Website-Strategy.md` (if present)

End of user manual